

Practice Paper 29 — Answer Scheme

Paper 2 — Comprehension

Sections B & C

Note to teachers and students

- Marks are awarded for **meaning**, not for exact words. Where a quotation is required, it has been indicated in inverted commas.
- Where the question asks for **own words**, a candidate who lifts directly from the text receives **zero** for that mark unless the lifted phrase is unavoidable.
- For language and tone questions, accept any reasonable alternative that clearly fits the textual evidence.

Section B — Text 3 Answer Scheme [20 marks]

Q1. [2] — “The camera at my hip wanted somewhere new”

Award **1 mark** for understanding that the narrator is **led by the camera / treats photography as instinct**; **1 mark** for explaining that he seeks **unfamiliar settings** in order to find fresh pictures.

Sample answer: The phrase suggests that the narrator works **instinctively**, as if the camera itself were guiding him; he constantly seeks **new and unfamiliar places** in order to find pictures he has not already taken.

Q2. [2] — Details suggesting an ordinary afternoon

1 mark each for any two of:

- He boarded the late tram “for no better reason than to use the last of the afternoon light”.
- He mentions the “usual mild Saturday”.
- He expected “two boys on skateboards, perhaps, an old man feeding pigeons”.
- He describes these as “the small ordinary scenes I had been taught to look for”.

Reject: “I had not expected a crowd” — this is the contrast, not the hint of ordinariness.

Q3. [2] — “The patient stillness of a queue”

1 mark for identifying that the comparison conveys **orderliness / quiet patience**; **1 mark** for explaining that the image of a queue suggests the crowd is **waiting calmly, without disturbance**, which is unexpected for a protest.

Sample answer: The comparison to a queue suggests that the crowd was **unusually orderly and patient**. Like people waiting in line, they stood quietly and without complaint, which makes the gathering feel disciplined rather than angry or chaotic.

Q4. [2] — “The hand often saw a picture before the eye had named it”

1 mark — Unusual: The hand is described as if it could **see** — a sense it does not possess; the action is given to the wrong body part.

1 mark — Suggestion: It shows that the narrator's photography is **deeply instinctive / automatic**: years of practice mean that he reacts before he has consciously thought about the scene.

Q5. [2] — “The tourist”

(a) [1]: It suggests he sees himself as an **outsider** — someone passing through, treating other people's serious lives as a **spectacle** or **sight to be photographed** rather than something to engage with.

(b) [1]: The word **hot** conveys a **sudden, physical, almost involuntary** feeling of shame; it shows the realisation has hit him **quickly** and **bodily**, not just intellectually.

Q6. [3] — The girl's calm and reasonable request (language question)

1 mark for identifying that the language **avoids anger** / makes her sound polite; **1 mark each** for **two** clearly quoted and explained details (max 2).

Accept any two of:

- “she did not look angry” — explicit statement that she is not hostile.
- “Excuse me” / “Would you mind” — **polite, measured phrasing** of the request.
- “without heat, without performance” — she speaks **without emotion or drama**.
- “as a reasonable request between reasonable people” — directly frames the exchange as **mutual courtesy**.
- “as one might ask a stranger to pass the salt” — comparison to an **everyday, trivial request**.

Each detail must be **quoted** and **explained**; mere lifting without explanation = ½ mark.

Q7. [2] — “An instrument I had forgotten how to play”

1 mark for understanding the comparison: the camera is being likened to a **musical instrument**.

1 mark for explaining that the narrator feels **suddenly unskilled / disoriented** — what was once second nature now feels **foreign and useless** in his hand. (Also accept: he no longer knows how to **use** the camera properly in this situation.)

Q8. [1] — “The point”

1 mark: He has understood that the girl, like the other protesters, **wanted to be part of a group rather than singled out**; her **anonymity within the crowd** was itself a deliberate choice, not an accident.

Q9. [1] — Evidence that his view of his profession has shifted

1 mark — Any **one** of:

- He realises he had been carrying a “**small, hard certainty**” — “that any scene was... mine to record”.
- He says he “had never thought of it as a certainty before”.
- He says he had thought of it “as a profession” — implying he now sees it as something more than that.

- The girl had “shown me a door I had not known was closed”.

Q10. [2] — “Let[s] the picture go”

1 mark — He has become **willing to give up photographs he could have taken** rather than take them without consent.

1 mark — This shows a shift from valuing the picture **above the subject** to placing **the subject’s wishes above the photograph** — a more ethical, consent-based approach.

Q11. [1] — Tone of the final sentence

1 mark — Any **one** of: **reflective, accepting, settled, quietly assured, unregretful**. (Reject: **sad, angry, bitter** — these miss the calm acceptance.)

Section C — Text 4 Answer Scheme [25 marks]

Q12. [2] — “Invisible piles... untouched and largely unseen”

1 mark for understanding **invisible piles** — photographs are stored **digitally** on phones, so there is no physical evidence that they exist.

1 mark for understanding **untouched and largely unseen** — once taken, the photos are **never looked at again** or revisited by the owner.

Q13. [2] — How many more photographs are taken now

1 mark each for any two of:

- About **1.8 trillion** photographs were taken globally in 2023.
- The great majority are taken **on smartphones**.
- This is **more than were taken in the entire twentieth century** combined.

Q14. [2] — “Not deleted; simply buried”

1 mark — **Deleted** would mean the owner had **actively chosen** to remove the photo; the photo would be gone on purpose.

1 mark — **Buried** means the photo **still exists**, but it is **hidden under so many others** that the owner never sees it again — the loss is **passive and accidental** rather than deliberate. The writer draws the distinction to show that the loss is **not a decision** but a **side effect** of taking too many pictures.

Q15. [2] — “A printed album required choice”

1 mark: Each **frame of film** was **limited in number and expensive**, so the photographer had to **think carefully** before taking a picture.

1 mark: The smartphone **removes this cost and limit**, so people now take **enormous numbers** of pictures **without deciding** which ones actually matter; choice has been **engineered out** of the process.

Q16. [2] — “What is gained in volume is lost in attention”

1 mark — The phrase is a **neat antithesis / balanced contrast** between two opposing ideas: more pictures versus less care.

1 mark — It captures the writer’s key argument in **one memorable line**: that the sheer **quantity** of pictures has come at the cost of any meaningful **engagement** with them.

Q17. [2] — “Small private histories”

1 mark — **Private** — the album belonged to one family and recorded **their own** lives, not the public record.

1 mark — **History** — it preserved the past for future generations, allowing them to see **who was present, what life looked like**; the word **small** gives the family album the weight of historical writing while keeping it modest and personal.

Q18. [2] — A camera roll “does not arrange itself into a story” (own words)

1 mark — Photos on a phone are simply **stored in the order they were taken**; nothing **organises** them or links them together.

1 mark — A **true family record** requires someone to **select, caption and order** the pictures so that they make sense to a later viewer; without this **human curation**, the images do not form a meaningful narrative.

Reject answers that lift “arrange itself into a story” without rewording.

Q19. [2] — Practices that restore choice

1 mark each for any two of:

- **Shared albums via dedicated apps** that send a weekly digest to grandparents.
- The “**best photo of the day**” rule that couples pin to a shared album.
- **Specialist services** that print a year of photographs into a bound book, **de-duplicating** and **selecting**.
- **Cloud services** offering unlimited storage (accept — though this is more storage than curation; award if linked to the family’s chosen selection).

Q20. [1] — Tone of “a quiet rebellion against the endless scroll”

1 mark — **Approving / quietly admiring / wryly hopeful**. (Also accept: **gently optimistic**.)

Reject: **sarcastic, bitter, angry.**

Q21. [2] — “A photograph that is not chosen is, in a quiet way, not really kept”

1 mark — It is a **paradox / quietly arresting statement**: although the photo technically still exists, the writer claims it has not truly been **preserved**.

1 mark — The phrase **redefines “keeping”** — to keep a photograph is not merely to **store** it, but to **select, value and revisit** it; this restates the article’s central argument in a **memorable closing form**.

Q22. Summary [13 marks total: 6 content + 7 style]

Content points (½ mark each, max 6 marks). **Eight available content points; candidates should aim for all 8.**

Why family photo albums have largely disappeared (Paragraphs 3–4):

1. Smartphones **remove the cost and limit** of film, so people take **vast numbers** of pictures.
2. There is **no longer any moment of curation / selection**.
3. Camera rolls do not **organise themselves**; without human captioning and ordering, they form **no coherent record**.
4. When phones are replaced or cloud accounts close, images may **quietly vanish unnoticed**.

What families are doing to bring back the album’s value (Paragraphs 5–6):

5. **Shared family albums** through apps that send weekly digests to relatives.
6. **Self-imposed rules** such as a “best photo a day” pinned to a shared album.
7. **Specialist services** that automatically print a year of photographs into a bound book.
8. **Small home printers** and **physical scrapbooking** are quietly returning, especially among parents and teenagers; schools also request **printed photographs** for displays.

Sample full-marks summary (78 words):

Family photo albums have faded because smartphones removed the cost and limit of film, encouraging huge numbers of pictures with no moment of selection; camera rolls do not organise themselves, and images may quietly vanish when devices or accounts change. Families are adapting, however, by sharing curated albums through apps that send weekly digests, agreeing rules such as one best photo a day, paying services to print bound yearbooks, and returning to home printers and physical scrapbooking.

Length count: 78 words from “Family” onwards.

— END OF ANSWER SCHEME —